Experiment 2

Setting Up a Zoho Creator Account and Exploring the Platform Architecture and Interface

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Aim

To create a Zoho Creator account and study its platform architecture, features and user interface by building a simple low-code application.

Theory

Zoho Creator is a cloud-based low-code platform used to build custom business applications with little hand-written code. An **Application** is the container that holds every other component. **Forms** collect data from users through fields such as text, number, date, email, phone and drop-down. **Reports** display and manage the records that forms store. **Pages** are custom interfaces and dashboards built from elements like charts, gauges and buttons. **Workflows** automate actions when events occur, such as a record being created or edited. **Deluge** is Zoho's scripting language for adding custom logic to workflows. **Users and Permissions** control who can view or change each part of the application.

Procedure

1. Open a web browser and go to the Zoho Creator website.
2. Create a Zoho account, or sign in with existing credentials.
3. Open the Zoho Creator dashboard.
4. Create a new application (blank or from a template). Here, *Student Admission Enquiry Management* was created.
5. Explore the Application Builder interface.
6. Open the Form Designer and add sample fields such as name, date, email, phone, number and drop-down.
7. Open the Report Builder and view the records generated from the form.
8. Look through the Workflow section to understand the automation options.
9. Explore Pages, Settings, User Management and Application Permissions.
10. Observe the overall platform architecture and note the function of each component.

Output Screenshots

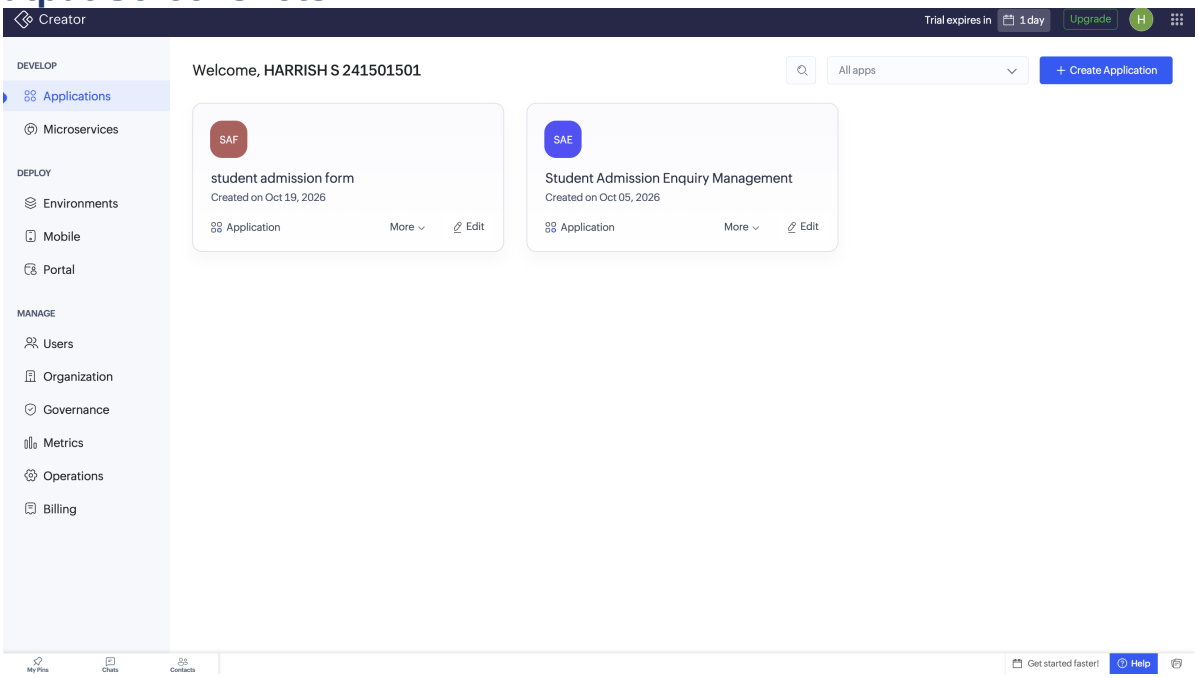


Figure 1: Zoho Creator home dashboard listing the student admission form and Student Admission Enquiry Management applications.

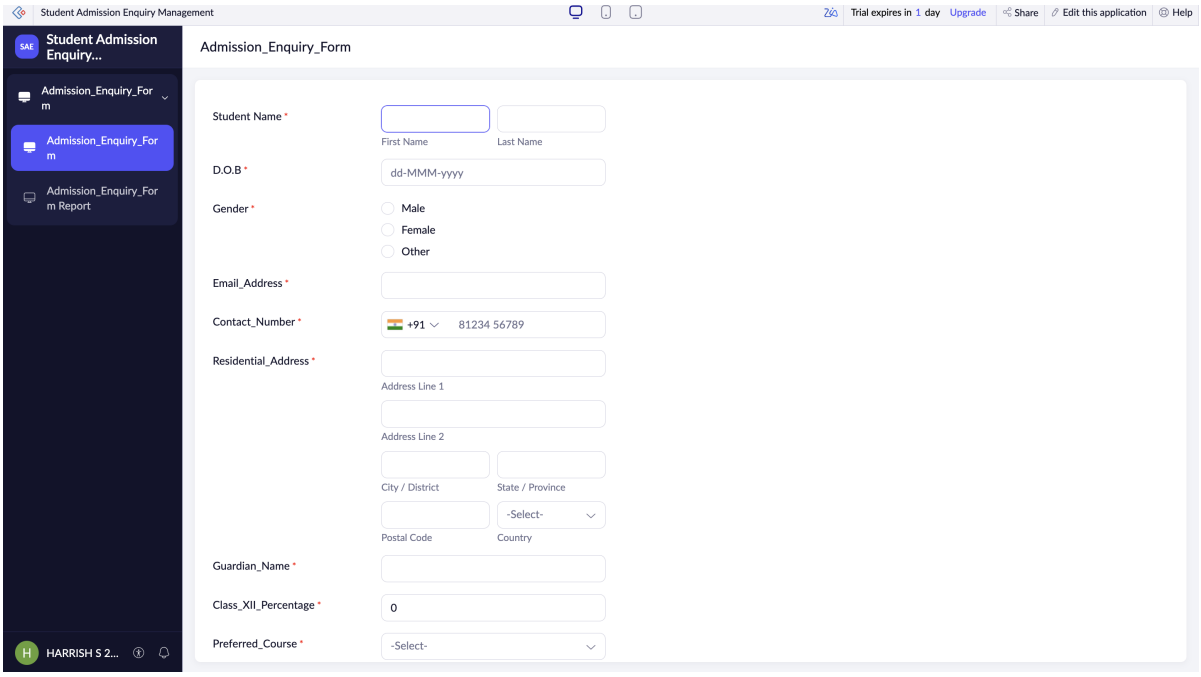


Figure 2: Admission_Enquiry_Form in the live application, showing the Student Name, D.O.B, Gender, contact, address, guardian, Class XII percentage and preferred course fields.

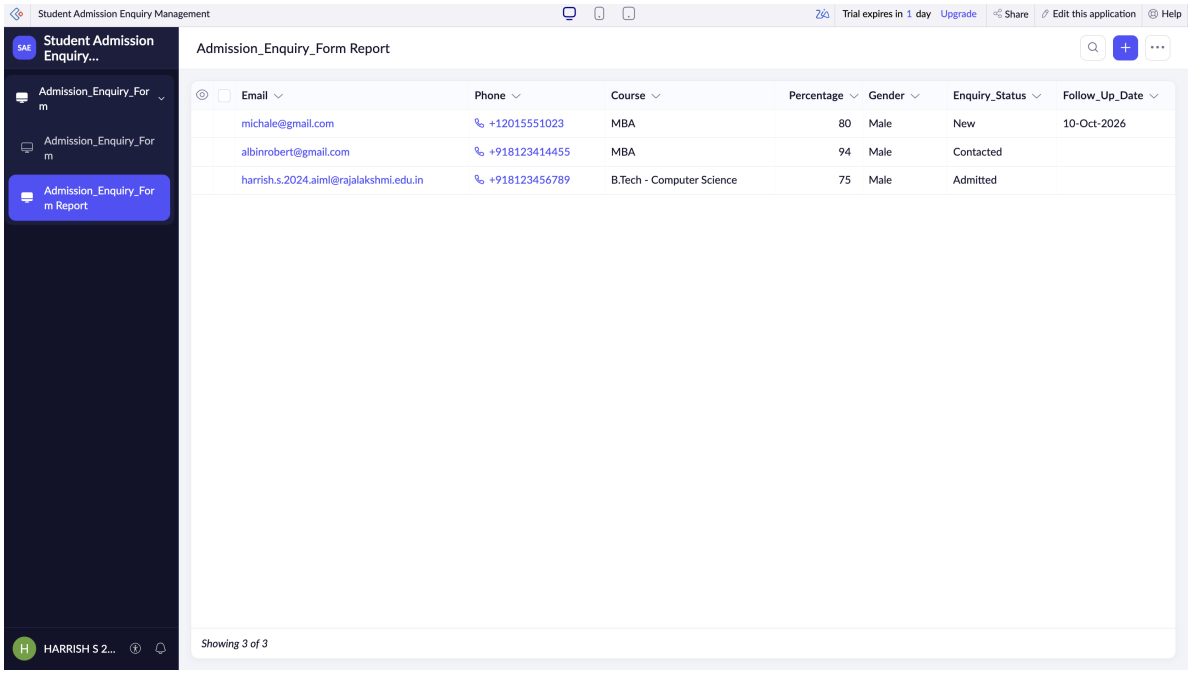


Figure 3: Admission_Enquiry_Form Report displaying the saved records (Email, Phone, Course, Percentage, Gender, Enquiry_Status and Follow_Up_Date).

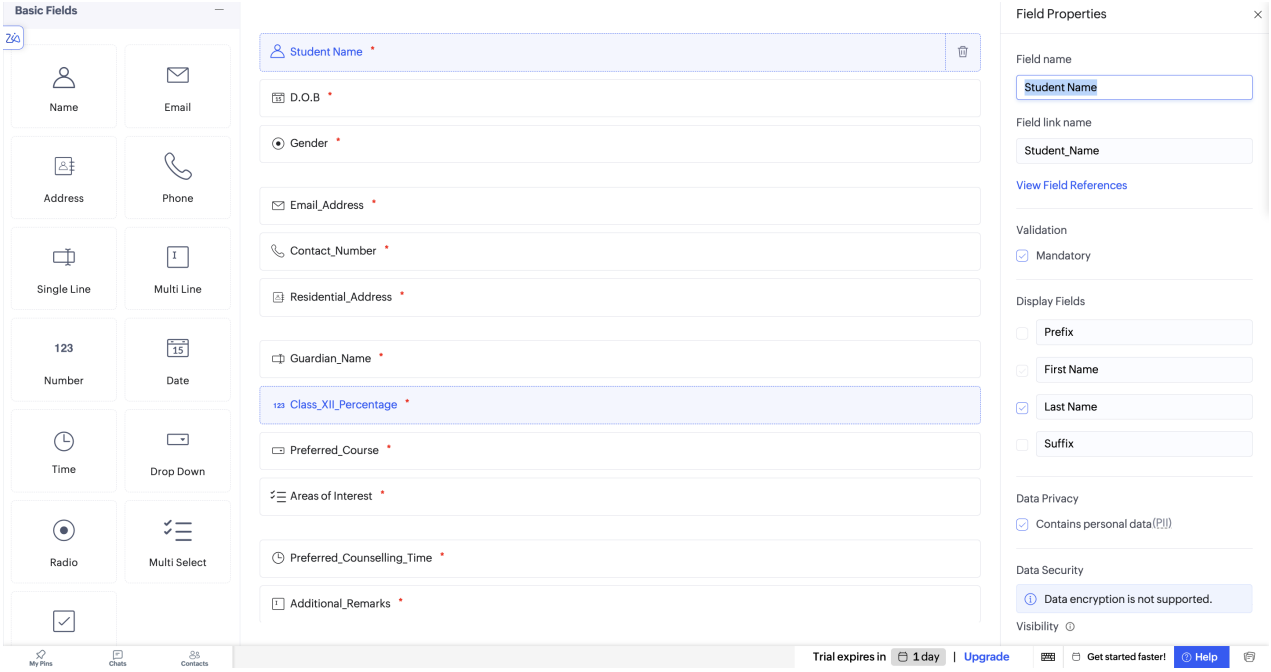


Figure 4: Form Builder showing the Basic Fields palette, the form's field layout and the Field Properties panel for Student Name.

Result

A Zoho Creator account was created and the platform's architecture and interface were explored. A Student Admission Enquiry Management application was built with a form, a report showing the stored records, and a form-builder view for configuring fields. The experiment showed that Zoho Creator offers an easy low-code environment, with forms, reports, pages and workflows, that allows applications to be developed quickly with minimal programming.